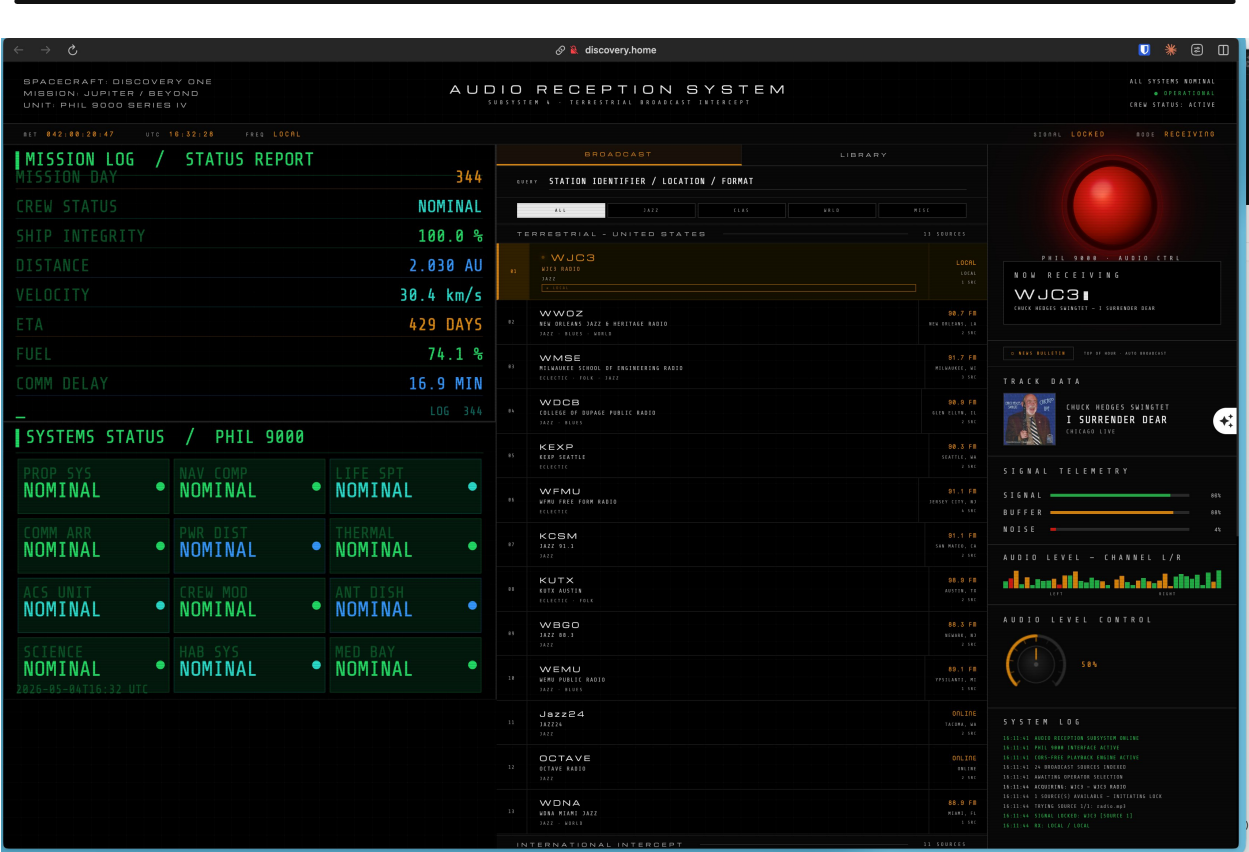


The Console

A personal music interface built for listeners, not algorithms.

Concept summary — May 2026



PHIL 9000 — working proof of concept

The Problem

Streaming services have turned music listening into a marketing experience. Every screen is a billboard. Every session begins with promoted content, algorithmic suggestions, and imagery designed to keep users scrolling — not listening. The music itself has become secondary to the platform's agenda.

At the same time, a growing segment of listeners — particularly those who remember owning their music — want something different. They want to sit down, put something on, and just listen. No distractions. No marketing. Full control.

The Idea

The Console is a beautifully designed, fully customizable music listening interface. It connects to the audio sources a user already has — their personal music library, public radio streams, and major streaming services — and presents them in a single, distraction-free environment. Think of it as a high-end remote control with a face you design yourself.

"Just a way to listen to your records. No garbage. Fully yours."

Critically, The Console does not host, store, or stream any audio content. It is purely an interface layer — which keeps the legal and operational footprint minimal. The user points it at what they already have, and it makes it look and feel exactly how they want.

How It Works

Two backend dependencies, both open source and user-managed:

- **Navidrome** — self-hosted music library and playback server (Subsonic API)
- **AzuraCast** — self-hosted internet radio platform

The Console connects to these via standard APIs. The user configures two URLs, picks a theme, and the experience is live. No new infrastructure to run. No data migration.

Streaming service widgets (Spotify, Apple Music, Tidal) are optionally embedded inside the interface — contained within the user's console, stripped of their native marketing surfaces.

Product Tiers

Tier	Price	What You Get
Free	\$0	Curated public radio streams, basic player interface, 2 themes
Pro	Subscription	Connect personal library, all themes, full customization, streaming service widgets, zero ads or promoted content

Target Audience

The primary user is not a technologist. They are someone who:

- Remembers what it felt like to put a record on and just listen
- Is frustrated with the cost, ads, and algorithmic noise of streaming services
- Wants ownership and control over their listening experience
- Is not willing — or able — to configure their own server infrastructure

Secondary audience: self-hosters and audio enthusiasts who already run Navidrome or similar tools and want a premium interface for it. This community (r/selfhosted, r/musichoarder) is vocal, technically capable, and an ideal early adopter base for validation.

Why Now

Spotify recently crossed 250 million paid subscribers — yet user sentiment around the platform's direction has soured. Price increases, podcast pivots, and increasingly aggressive algorithmic promotion have alienated a meaningful segment of long-term users. Apple Music, Amazon, and Tidal face similar criticisms.

Meanwhile, self-hosted audio tools have matured significantly. Navidrome and AzuraCast are stable, well-documented, and free. The infrastructure problem is largely solved. The missing piece is an interface good enough to make the experience feel premium — not like a hobbyist project.

Copyright & Legal Position

The Console does not host, transmit, or distribute audio content of any kind. It is a display and control interface only. Public radio streams are publicly licensed. Personal libraries are owned by the user. Streaming service integrations operate through each platform's official embed or API. This positions The Console similarly to a media player application — not a streaming service — with a correspondingly clean legal profile.

Immediate Next Step

Before any development begins, validate demand with a single Reddit post in r/selfhosted or r/musichoarder. Share a screenshot of the existing PHIL 9000 interface — a working proof-of-concept — with the question: would you use this? The response will determine whether and how to proceed.

This is a passion project, not a funded venture. The goal at this stage is to find out if anyone else wants it.